

Word family: **trust** / trusts / trusted / trusting / trustworthy / trustworthiness / distrust / distrustful / mistrust / mistrustful / trustee

Base word: trust

Past tense / past participle: trusted

-ing form: trusting

Plural noun: trusts

Related forms:

* **trusting** (adj.) — 容易相信別人的；信任別人的

* **trustworthy** (adj.) — 值得信賴的；可靠的

* **trustworthiness** (n.) — 可信賴；可靠性

* **distrust** (n./v.) — 不信任；懷疑

* **distrustful** (adj.) — 不信任的；多疑的

* **mistrust** (n./v.) — 不信任；懷疑

* **mistrustful** (adj.) — 抱有懷疑的；不信任的

* **trustee** (n.) — 受託人；信託管理人

Useful extensions:

* **trust someone**

* **trust someone to do something**

* **trust someone with something**

* **trust in someone/something**

* **trust your instincts**

* **trust your judgment**

* **trust that...**

* **earn/build trust**

* **lose/break trust**

* **place/put your trust in**

* **a position of trust**

* **breach of trust**

* **public trust**

* **trust fund**

* **trustee**

* **trustworthy source**

Part of speech: mainly **verb** and **noun**

Core meaning

At its centre, **trust** is about:

****believing that someone or something is reliable, honest, safe, or likely to behave as expected — 信任；相信；信賴****

This core idea develops into several useful branches:

- * trusting a person
- * relying on someone to do something
- * entrusting something valuable to someone
- * believing information or judgment
- * confidence in systems or institutions
- * legal/financial ****trusts****

1. ****trust someone — 信任某人；相信某人可靠****

This is the most central interpersonal meaning.

Practice 1

> I ****trust her**** completely.

我完全****信任她****。

Practice 2

> It takes time to learn whether you can ****trust someone****.

要知道一個人是否****值得信任****，需要時間。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trust someone = 相信某人誠實、可靠，不會故意欺騙或傷害自己****

2. ****trust someone to do something — 相信某人會做好某事****

Here, you believe that the person will act properly or competently.

Practice 1

> I ****trust him to make the right decision****.

我****相信他會作出正確決定****。

Practice 2

> Can we **trust her to keep the information private**?

我們可以**相信她會把這些資料保密**嗎？

MCQ-ready definition:

trust someone to do something = 相信某人會負責任、可靠地完成某件事

3. **trust someone with something — 把重要 / 珍貴的東西交託給某人**

This adds the idea of **entrusting responsibility**.

Practice 1

> I wouldn't **trust him with my car**.

我不會放心**把我的車交給他保管 / 使用**。

Practice 2

> She **trusted me with a secret**.

她**信任我，把一個秘密告訴了我**。

MCQ-ready definition:

trust someone with something = 因相信某人可靠，而把重要、私人或有價值的東西交給他處理或保管

4. **trust someone with doing something — 信任某人負責某事**

Practice 1

> They **trusted her with managing the project**.

他們**信任她，讓她負責管理這個項目**。

Practice 2

> I wouldn't **trust him with handling the money**.

我不會**放心讓他處理那筆錢**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trust someone with doing something = 把某項責任交給某人，因為相信他有能力而且可靠****

5. ****trust something — 相信某事物可靠 / 準確****

****Trust**** does not only apply to people.

Practice 1

> I don't ****trust this old machine****.

我不太****相信這部舊機器可靠****。

Practice 2

> You shouldn't always ****trust information you see online****.

你不應該總是****相信網上看到的資訊****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trust something = 相信某個系統、物件、資訊或方法是可靠、準確或安全的****

6. ****trust that... — 相信.....；相信事情會如此****

Often slightly formal.

Practice 1

> I ****trust that you understand**** the importance of this matter.

我****相信你明白****這件事的重要性。

Practice 2

> We ****trust that the problem will be resolved soon****.

我們****相信這個問題很快會得到解決****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trust that... = 相信某件事是真的或會按預期發生****

7. **trust your instincts — 相信自己的直覺**

Practice 1

> Sometimes you have to **trust your instincts**.

有時候你必須**相信自己的直覺**。

Practice 2

> She **trusted her instincts** and decided not to go.

她**相信自己的直覺**，決定不去。

MCQ-ready definition:

trust your instincts = 相信自己沒有經過詳細分析而自然產生的直覺判斷

8. **trust your judgment — 相信自己的判斷力**

Practice 1

> You need to learn to **trust your own judgment**.

你需要學會**相信自己的判斷力**。

Practice 2

> I **trust her judgment** when it comes to hiring staff.

在聘請員工方面，我**信任她的判斷**。

MCQ-ready definition:

trust someone's judgment = 相信某人的判斷通常可靠、合理

9. **trust your memory / senses — 相信自己的記憶 / 感官**

Practice 1

> I don't **trust my memory** enough to answer without checking.

我不太**相信自己的記憶**，所以要先查清楚才回答。

Practice 2

> In the dark, he couldn't fully **trust his eyes**.

在黑暗中，他不能完全**相信自己看到的東西**。

MCQ-ready definition:

trust your memory/senses = 相信自己的記憶或感官所提供的資訊是準確的

10. **trust in someone/something** — 對.....有信心；信賴

This is often slightly more abstract than plain **trust someone**.

Practice 1

> She has great **trust in her team**.

她對自己的團隊非常**有信心 / 信任**。

Practice 2

> Many people place their **trust in science**.

很多人對科學抱有**信賴**。

MCQ-ready definition:

trust in someone/something = 對某人、制度、理念或事物抱有**信心和信賴**

11. **trust (noun)** — 信任；信賴

Practice 1

> A good relationship depends on **trust**.

良好的關係有賴**信任**。

Practice 2

> Once **trust** is lost, it can be difficult to rebuild.

一旦失去**信任**，就可能很難重新建立。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trust = 相信某人或某事可靠、誠實、安全的心理狀態****

12. ****earn someone's trust — 贏得某人的信任****

Practice 1

> It took months for him to ****earn her trust****.

他花了幾個月才****贏得她的信任****。

Practice 2

> Good leaders must ****earn the trust**** of their teams.

優秀的領導者必須****贏得團隊的信任****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****earn someone's trust = 透過行為證明自己可靠，從而令某人開始信任自己****

13. ****build trust — 建立信任****

Practice 1

> Honest communication helps ****build trust****.

坦誠溝通有助****建立信任****。

Practice 2

> It takes time to ****build trust**** between two people.

兩個人之間需要時間才能****建立信任****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****build trust = 逐步建立彼此的信任感****

14. ****gain someone's trust — 取得某人的信任****

Practice 1

> She slowly **gained the child's trust**.

她慢慢**取得了那個孩子的信任**。

Practice 2

> A doctor needs to **gain the trust of patients**.

醫生需要**取得病人的信任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

gain someone's trust = 成功令某人開始信任自己

15. **lose someone's trust — 失去某人的信任**

Practice 1

> He lied repeatedly and eventually **lost her trust**.

他多次說謊，最後**失去了她的信任**。

Practice 2

> A company can quickly **lose public trust** after a serious scandal.

公司發生嚴重醜聞後，可能很快**失去公眾信任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

lose someone's trust = 因行為令人失望或懷疑，而令對方不再信任自己

16. **break / betray someone's trust — 辜負 / 背叛某人的信任**

Practice 1

> She felt that he had **betrayed her trust**.

她覺得他**背叛了她的信任**。

Practice 2

> Sharing that private information would **break his trust**.

公開那些私人資料會**破壞他對你的信任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

betray/break someone's trust = 做出違反對方面信任的事情，使信任關係受到破壞

17. **restore / rebuild trust** — 恢復 / 重建信任

Practice 1

> The company is trying to **rebuild public trust**.

公司正努力**重建公眾信任**。

Practice 2

> An apology alone may not be enough to **restore trust**.

單靠道歉可能不足以**恢復信任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

restore/rebuild trust = 在信任受損後重新建立信賴

18. **place / put your trust in someone** — 把信任寄託於某人

Slightly more formal.

Practice 1

> She **placed her trust in** the wrong person.

她**錯信了**一個人。

Practice 2

> Many people **put their trust in** experienced professionals.

很多人會**信賴**有經驗的專業人士。

MCQ-ready definition:

place/put your trust in someone = 選擇相信並依賴某人

19. **a position of trust — 受信任的重要職位**

Practice 1

> Teachers hold a **position of trust**.

教師身處一個**需要高度信任的職位**。

Practice 2

> He abused his **position of trust**.

他濫用了自己的**受信任地位**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a position of trust = 因職責涉及重要責任、私人資料或他人利益而需要高度可信賴的職位

20. **breach of trust — 違背信任；失信**

Formal/legal/business use.

Practice 1

> The disclosure was seen as a serious **breach of trust**.

這次披露被視為嚴重的**違背信任行為**。

Practice 2

> Misusing confidential information can amount to a **breach of trust**.

濫用機密資料可能構成**違反信任責任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

breach of trust = 違反別人基於信任而交付的責任或義務

21. **public trust — 公眾信任**

Practice 1

> Transparency is essential for maintaining **public trust**.

透明度對維持**公眾信任**非常重要。

Practice 2

> The incident damaged **public trust** in the organization.

事件損害了公眾對該機構的**信任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

public trust = 社會大眾對某機構、制度或人士可靠性與誠信的信心

22. **trustworthy** — 值得信賴的；可靠的

Practice 1

> She is honest and completely **trustworthy**.

她誠實，而且非常**值得信賴**。

Practice 2

> Make sure your information comes from a **trustworthy source**.

要確保你的資料來自**可靠的來源**。

MCQ-ready definition:

trustworthy = 值得別人相信其誠實、可靠或準確的

23. **trustworthiness** — 可信賴程度；可靠性

Practice 1

> Employers value honesty and **trustworthiness**.

僱主重視誠實和**可靠可信的品格**。

Practice 2

> We need to assess the **trustworthiness** of the source.

我們需要評估這個資料來源的**可信程度**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trustworthiness = 值得信賴或可靠的程度****

24. ****trusting — 容易相信別人的；信任別人的****

This is not simply the same as ****trustworthy****.

Practice 1

> She is naturally very ****trusting****.

她天性很****容易相信別人****。

Practice 2

> Young children can be extremely ****trusting****.

年幼的孩子有時會非常****容易信任別人****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trusting = 傾向容易相信別人誠實、可靠或沒有惡意的****

25. ****too trusting — 太容易相信別人的****

Practice 1

> He is sometimes ****too trusting**** of strangers.

他有時****太容易相信陌生人****。

Practice 2

> Being ****too trusting**** can make you vulnerable to scams.

****過分容易相信別人****可能令你容易受騙。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****too trusting = 對別人的信任過多，缺乏足夠警覺****

26. **distrust** (verb) — 不信任；懷疑

Practice 1

> She **distrusted** him from the beginning.

她從一開始就**不信任**他。

Practice 2

> Many consumers **distrust** claims that sound too good to be true.

很多消費者會**懷疑**那些好得令人難以置信的宣稱。

MCQ-ready definition:

distrust = 不相信某人或某事可靠、誠實或可信

27. **distrust** (noun) — 不信任；猜疑

Practice 1

> Years of conflict created deep **distrust** between the two groups.

多年的衝突令兩個群體之間產生深深的**不信任**。

Practice 2

> There is widespread **distrust** of the system.

人們普遍對這個制度抱有**不信任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

distrust = 不相信某人或某事可靠的心理狀態

28. **mistrust** — 不信任；懷疑

Mistrust overlaps strongly with **distrust**.

Practice 1

> She had learned to **mistrust** strangers.

她已學會對陌生人保持**戒心 / 不輕易信任**。

Practice 2

> His behaviour created an atmosphere of **mistrust**.

他的行為造成了一種**彼此不信任的氣氛**。

MCQ-ready definition:

mistrust = 對某人的誠意、動機或可靠性抱有懷疑

29. **trust fund** (法律 / 金融) — 信託基金

This is a genuine domain-specific extension.

Practice 1

> Her grandparents set up a **trust fund** for her education.

她的祖父母為她的教育設立了一個**信託基金**。

Practice 2

> The money is held in a **trust fund** until he turns twenty-one.

這筆錢會存放在**信託基金**內，直至他二十一歲。

MCQ-ready definition:

trust fund = 由受託人為指定受益人持有和管理的資產或基金

30. **trust** (法律 : 信託) — 信託安排 / 信託

In legal and financial English, **trust** has a distinct technical meaning.

Practice 1

> The property is held in **trust** for the children.

這項物業以**信託形式**為孩子持有。

Practice 2

> They created a **trust** to manage the family's assets.

他們設立了一個**信託**來管理家族資產。

MCQ-ready definition:

trust = 一種法律安排，由受託人為另一人或群體的利益持有及管理財產

31. **trustee** — 受託人；信託管理人

Practice 1

> The **trustee** manages the assets on behalf of the beneficiaries.

受託人代表受益人管理資產。

Practice 2

> She was appointed as a **trustee** of the charity.

她獲委任為該慈善機構的**受託人**。

MCQ-ready definition:

trustee = 依法負責為他人利益管理信託財產，或負責管理某組織的人

Important distinction 1: **trust** vs **believe**

These overlap, but they are not the same.

believe someone

= think what they say is true

> I **believe you**.

我相信你說的話。

trust someone

= believe they are honest, reliable, safe, or dependable

> I **trust you**.

我信任你。

You can believe one particular statement without fully trusting the person.

Important distinction 2: **trust vs rely on**

trust

focuses on confidence in honesty, reliability, or judgment.

rely on

focuses on depending on someone/something for practical support.

> I **trust her**.

我信任她。

> I **rely on her** to help me with the accounts.

我依靠她幫我處理帳目。

Often the ideas overlap, but the emphasis differs.

Important distinction 3: **trust vs confidence**

trust

often concerns reliability, honesty, safety, or faith in someone.

confidence

often concerns belief in ability or expected success.

> I **trust him** with confidential information.

我信任他處理機密資料。

> I have **confidence in his ability**.

我對他的能力有信心。

Important distinction 4: **trust someone** vs **trust in someone**

trust someone

ordinary direct interpersonal trust

> I **trust her**.

我信任她。

trust in someone

more abstract or formal; emphasizes faith/confidence

> They have complete **trust in their leader**.

他們完全信賴自己的領導者。

For everyday conversation, **trust someone** is usually simpler.

Important distinction 5: **trust someone to do X** vs **trust someone with X**

trust someone to do X

believe they will do an action properly

> I **trust him to finish the work**.

我相信他會完成工作。

trust someone with X

give them responsibility for something important

> I **trust him with the money**.

我放心把錢交給他處理。

Important distinction 6: **trusting** vs **trustworthy**

This distinction is extremely important.

trusting

= a person **gives trust easily**

> She is very **trusting**.

她很容易相信別人。

trustworthy

= a person **deserves trust**

> She is very **trustworthy**.

她很值得信任。

So:

* **trusting** → 信任別人的

* **trustworthy** → 值得別人信任的

They describe opposite sides of the relationship.

Important distinction 7: **distrust** vs **mistrust**

They overlap heavily.

distrust

often suggests a fairly definite lack of trust.

mistrust

often suggests suspicion or uneasiness about someone's motives/reliability.

But in ordinary English, the difference is often small.

> I **distrust** him.

> I **mistrust** him.

Both can mean:

****我不信任他。****

Important distinction 8: ****trust vs faith****

****trust****

common in everyday relationships and reliability.

****faith****

can mean strong confidence without complete proof; it also has religious uses.

> I ****trust my friend****.

我信任我的朋友。

> I have ****faith in her ability to recover****.

我對她能康復抱有信心。

So ****faith**** can sound deeper, broader, or more abstract.

Important distinction 9: ****trustworthy vs reliable****

****trustworthy****

strongly emphasizes honesty and being deserving of trust.

****reliable****

emphasizes consistently doing what is expected.

> a ****trustworthy person****

一個值得信任的人

> a ****reliable machine****

一部可靠的機器

A person can be both, but the nuances differ.

Important distinction 10: **trust vs certainty**

To **trust** something does not mean you have absolute proof.

> I **trust his judgment**.

means:

I believe his judgment is dependable.

It does not necessarily mean:

I am 100% certain he cannot be wrong.

Trust always contains an element of confidence rather than perfect certainty.

Important distinction 11: **earn trust vs demand trust**

Trust normally has to develop through behaviour.

> You **earn trust**.

= 透過行動贏得信任

> You **demand trust**.

= 要求別人信任你

The second does not mean people actually trust you.

Important distinction 12: **lose trust vs betray trust**

lose trust

describes the result:

> She **lost my trust**.

她失去了我的信任。

betray trust

describes the act that violates trust:

> She **betrayed my trust**.

她辜負 / 背叛了我的信任。

Family-extension note

Trust is a strong polysemy family, but its everyday meanings remain tightly connected around one semantic core:

confidence in reliability, honesty, safety, accuracy, or expected behaviour

The main everyday branches include:

- * interpersonal trust
- * trusting someone to perform a task
- * entrusting something to someone
- * confidence in information, judgment, memory, or systems
- * the noun meaning of confidence/reliance

The major genuinely separate domain-specific branch is the **legal/financial sense**:

* **a trust**

* **trust fund**

* **trustee**

That branch should be clearly separated from ordinary emotional/interpersonal **trust**, because it refers to a formal legal arrangement rather than merely confidence between people.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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trust someone	信任某人	believe person is reliable/honest
trust someone to do X	相信某人會做好 X	confidence in action
trust someone with X	把 X 交託給某人	entrust responsibility

trust something	相信某物 / 資訊可靠	confidence in reliability	
trust that...	相信.....	believe proposition	
trust your instincts	相信直覺	rely on instinct	
trust your judgment	相信判斷力	rely on judgment	
trust your memory	相信記憶	rely on memory	
trust in someone/something	信賴；對.....有信心	abstract confidence	
trust (noun)	信任；信賴	confidence/reliance	
earn trust	贏得信任	cause others to trust you	
build trust	建立信任	develop trust gradually	
gain trust	取得信任	successfully become trusted	
lose trust	失去信任	confidence disappears	
betray trust	背叛 / 辜負信任	violate trust	
rebuild trust	重建信任	restore confidence	
put/place trust in	信賴；把信任寄託於	choose to rely on	
position of trust	受信任職位	role requiring reliability	
breach of trust	違背信任	violation of entrusted duty	
public trust	公眾信任	society's confidence	
trusting	容易相信別人的	gives trust readily	
trustworthy	值得信賴的	deserves trust	
trustworthiness	可信賴程度	quality of being trustworthy	
distrust	不信任	lack of trust	
mistrust	懷疑；不信任	suspicion	
trust (legal)	信託	legal arrangement	
trust fund	信託基金	assets held in trust	
trustee	受託人	person managing trust assets	

Core takeaway

The most important semantic structure is:

****trust = believe someone/something is dependable****

→ ****trust someone to do something**** = 相信對方會做好

→ ****trust someone with something**** = 因為信任而把重要東西交託給對方

→ ****trust (noun)**** = 信任本身

→ ****trustworthy**** = 值得信任

→ ****trusting**** = 容易信任別人

And the one contrast I would definitely make students memorize is:

****trusting ≠ trustworthy****

* ****a trusting person**** = ****容易相信別人的人****

* ****a trustworthy person**** = ****值得別人信任的人****